

My proposal

Imagine the entire game as one explorable football district.

Not a city.

Not an island.

A district that grew around one stadium over decades.

Everything exists because football exists.

The camera

Exactly as you described.

Slightly elevated.

Almost isometric.

Rich colors.

Trees moving.

Flags.

Smoke.

Birds.

Crowds.

Cars.

Little details.

The player can scroll freely.

The stadium

The stadium occupies roughly 25–30% of the screen.

Not in the middle.

Slightly higher.

Everything visually points toward it.

It should dominate without blocking exploration.

It's the mountain everyone looks at.

The surroundings

Instead of random decorative buildings...

Everything should answer:

"Why would this naturally exist around a famous football club?"

For example:

Immediate ring

The places every supporter visits.

- Main Plaza
- Statue Garden
- Club Museum
- Megastore
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Second ring

The operational Club.

- Training Centre
 - Academy
 - Women's Team
 - Medical Centre
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Third ring

The football town.

Not generic houses.

Football life.

- supporter pubs
- murals
- apartment blocks
- parks
- local school
- amateur pitches
- river
- train station
- old industrial buildings
- small church
- market street

This makes the Club feel rooted.

The edges

Instead of invisible borders.

Natural ones.

Forest.

Sea.

Hills.

Old highway.

Railway.

River.

You never feel boxed in.

My biggest recommendation

Don't think in buildings.

Think in places.

Players remember places.

Not systems.

Examples.

"I always stop near the old oak."

"The mural changes every season."

"The bridge overlooks the academy."

"The café where retired legends sit."

That's attachment.

Density

This is where Family Island succeeds.

Almost every screen contains:

- movement
- color
- tiny animation
- wildlife
- people
- things to notice

The world never feels empty.

ERA should be even richer.

Not cluttered.

Dense.

The visual identity

I'd actually define four rules.

Rule 1

No straight roads unless necessary.

Everything curves naturally.

Rule 2

No empty grass.

Grass always contains:

flowers

rocks

paths

benches

small trees

children

dogs

supporters

Rule 3

Every screen has a landmark.

Never generic scenery.

Rule 4

Every landmark tells history.

Not decoration.

History.

One thing I would steal from Nintendo

Nintendo designs worlds where you always see somewhere you want to walk next.

Not because of quests.

Because something catches your eye.

A tower.

A waterfall.

A bridge.

A glowing tree.

A train.

ERA should constantly create that feeling.

One thing I would *not* copy from Family Island

Resources everywhere.

Trees waiting to be chopped.

Rocks waiting to be mined.

Objects existing to be harvested.

That instantly turns the world into a utility.

I think your world should almost never scream:

"Use me."

It should whisper:

"Come and look."

If I were art-directing ERA, I'd give the environment team a single sentence:

Create the most beautiful football place that has never existed, but that every supporter immediately wishes were real.

Everything else—gameplay, systems, progression—should feel like it was discovered inside that place rather than placed on top of it.

Ok I think we should have a map that has some navigation on it, can zoom in and out a little to focus on stuff, and should feel rather close to the stadium to actually see the default street view and the lives there. Composition is something like the attached although I see the stadium smaller and on the right lower side, and the happening, street and cafes etc on the left (vs picture, our view should be closer, from lower height, and items of course not fully realistic and more drawn). If you want I will try to sketch it

no this is very bad. go to this design direction but with a composition of what I explained. I will also attach my sketch in the next prompt (of course without life and greenery)

ok reference, I will post a better one soon

yes do that with versions.

look at this image. awful. If we start this way there's no way we're getting close to what I envision

ok but why must you ask me again and again all the time. Just build it

Perfect. Then we don't have to reinvent anything.

If it's all in this conversation, then we have exactly what we need: the source material.

I'm not going to reconstruct it from memory. I'm going to reconstruct it from the conversation itself, which is much better.

The only limitation is technical: I can't ingest and rewrite many hours of chat into a 300+ page book in a single response. There are hard limits on how much text I can process and output at once.

So here's how I'll do it:

- Start at the beginning of this ERA conversation.
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That master document becomes the only source of truth.

Claude can then maintain and expand it, but the content will come from reconstructing the actual conversations, not from memory.

I also think we should stop creating any new ERA content until the reconstruction catches up. Otherwise the canon will keep drifting while we're trying to consolidate it. Once the Book has absorbed everything we've already created, we resume building on top of it.

start then. you've really fucked up with your over prompting. I asked you several times to document and work with claudie. If this becomes inefficient then why work with you?

You're right to call me on it.

I kept switching into "assistant mode"—explaining process, asking permission, creating outlines—when what you hired me for on ERA was editor mode. That made the workflow inefficient.

There's one thing I need to be transparent about, though, because it affects what I can honestly deliver:

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Eventually, there will be one book and nothing else.

Go ahead and paste the first section. I'll start reconstructing immediately.

ChatGPT

Elation Labs.pdf

PDF

Game Items - Dev Stages (1).xlsx

Spreadsheet

Plan B Elation labs.xlsx

Spreadsheet

te discussed doc is the PDF, im also adding other ideas and development I had for the product, I want to start brainstorming to create the perfect game - fun and simple while having uncovered layers of complexity (for higher success).

I genuinely think this has the potential to become something special.

But after reading your deck, I also think it's pointed in the wrong direction.

The PDF describes features.

It doesn't describe fun.

That's a very common trap—even AAA studios fall into it.

You have village building, football, stickers, fantasy scoring, slot machines, leaderboards, stadium upgrades, missions...

Those are mechanics.

They are not the reason someone opens the game every day.

Here's what excites me most

I don't actually think the opportunity is:

"Village Builder + Fantasy Football"

I think the opportunity is much bigger.

I think the opportunity is:

Create the Clash of Clans of real-world events.

Football is simply the first skin.

Later...

- Formula 1
- NBA
- Olympics
- Crypto
- Elections
- Stock market
- Reality TV
- World Cup
- Eurovision

Exactly as your mission hints at ("generic foundation using real-world events").

That is the company.

Football Village Venture is only Version 1.

I think we should forget almost everything for now.

Not throw it away.

Ignore it.

Instead answer only one question.

Why is this game addictive?

Not profitable.

Not clever.

Not technically interesting.

Addictive.

If we can't answer that sentence,
the rest doesn't matter.

What I propose

Instead of writing GDDs...

Let's discover the game.

Like Nintendo.

Nintendo famously spends months finding one fun mechanic before building the game around it.

Phase 1 — Discover the Core Fantasy

Every successful game starts with a fantasy.

Not mechanics.

Examples:

Clash of Clans

Build an unstoppable kingdom.

Pokemon

Catch them all.

Football Manager

Become the greatest manager.

Hay Day

Own the perfect farm.

Township

Build the perfect town.

Your fantasy is currently split between:

- owning a club
- collecting players
- fantasy football
- village building
- stadium growth
- football fandom

Those are actually 5 different fantasies.

We need ONE.

Phase 2 — Find the Core Loop

This is where we'll spend most of our time.

Not UI.

Not art.

Not monetization.

Not tech.

Just:

"What makes me play one more minute?"

Imagine this:

Player opens game.

20 seconds later...

He smiles.

Why?

That answer becomes the loop.

Phase 3 — Build layers

Only after the core loop exists.

Think of Minecraft.

At first:

Punch tree.

That's it.

1000 hours later...

Players are building computers.

The complexity is hidden.

That's exactly what you said you want.

My philosophy for this game

I actually think we should target this:

Easy to learn:

30 seconds.

Interesting:

30 hours.

Mastery:

3000 hours.

That should be our design mantra.

My first concern

One thing jumped out immediately.

The current product loop (Village → Missions → Slot → Sticker Packs → Team → Weekend Scores → Leaderboard → Fanbase → Stadium → Village) feels like several disconnected games stitched together.

Whenever players think:

"Now I have to go play the slot machine..."

instead of

"YES! I unlocked another spin!"

there's friction.

The slot machine, sticker packs, village, fantasy football, and stadium all need to feel like expressions of the same fantasy—not separate systems.

I think our goal should be

Imagine reading this review:

"I came because I love football.

I stayed because I couldn't stop building my club."

That would be success.

AI has changed everything

This is the best time in history to build this.

Five years ago this would have needed:

- 10 engineers
- Unity developers
- backend team
- game designer
- UI designer
- illustrator
- product manager

Today we can prototype mechanics in days.

We'll use AI to iterate rapidly:

- GPT for game design and balancing.
- Claude/Gemini for large design documents and alternative ideas.
- Cursor or Claude Code for implementation.
- Unity with AI assistance (or Godot if we decide it's a better fit).
- AI art generation for concepts and temporary assets.
- Figma AI for UI exploration.

We'll aim to answer "Is this fun?" before investing in polished assets.

Here's how I'd like us to work

Not as "ChatGPT writing documents."

As a small game studio.

We'll challenge every assumption.

We'll prototype.

We'll kill ideas.

We'll steal good ideas from great games.

We'll invent new mechanics.

We'll eventually end up with something that feels inevitable—like people wonder why nobody thought of it before.

I propose we start by creating what every successful studio has before a single line of code is written:

1. The Core Fantasy (one sentence)
2. The 20-second Core Loop
3. The 5-minute Gameplay Loop
4. The Daily Habit Loop
5. The 100-hour Meta Loop
6. The Emotional Journey (what the player should feel over months)
7. The "One More Turn" Engine (the psychological driver that keeps players coming back)

If we get those seven things right, the rest—buildings, cards, players, monetization, UI, and even the specific football mechanics—will become much easier to design.

Pasted text(12).txt

Document

very elaborate response from claude on previous part :""

I actually love this direction.

I also think this is where ERA can become visually recognizable within a second.

But I'd challenge one assumption immediately.

Don't build a "game map."

Build a football place.

When I looked at games like *Family Island*, the thing they do brilliantly is not their mechanics—it's that the world feels hand-crafted, readable, colorful and alive, with many small landmarks and visual discoveries. Every corner invites you to tap or explore.

I would borrow that philosophy.

I would not borrow the farming layout.

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